

The (First) Apocalypse of James

V 24,10-44,10

It is the Lord who spoke with me: “See now the completion of my redemption. I have given you a sign of these things, James, my brother. For not without reason have I called you my brother, although you are not my brother materially. And I am not ignorant concerning you; so that when I give you a sign—know and hear.

“Nothing existed except Him-who-is. He is unnameable and ineffable. I myself also am unnameable, from Him-who-is, just as I have been [given a] number of names—two from Him-who-is. And I, [I] am before you. Since you have [asked] concerning femaleness, femaleness existed, but femaleness was not [first]. And [it] prepared for itself powers and gods. But [it did] not exist [when] I came forth, since I am an image of Him-who-is. But I have brought forth the image of [him] so that the sons of Him-who-is might know what things are theirs and what things are alien (to them). Behold, I shall reveal to you everything of this mystery. For they will seize me the day after tomorrow. But my redemption will be near.”

James said, “Rabbi, you have said, ‘They will seize me.’ But I, what can I do?” He said to me, “Fear not, James. You too will they seize. But leave Jerusalem. For it is she who always gives the cup of bitterness to the sons of light. She is a dwelling place of a great number of archons. But your redemption will be preserved from them. So that you may understand who they are [and] what kinds they are, you will [...]. And listen. They [are] not [. . .] but [archons ...]. These twelve [...] down [...] archons [...] upon his own hebdomad.”

James said, “Rabbi, are there then twelve hebdomads and not seven as there are in the scriptures?” The Lord said, “James, he who spoke concerning this scripture had a limited understanding. I, however, shall reveal to you what has come forth from him who has no number. I shall give a sign concerning their number. As for what has come forth from him who has no measure, I shall give a sign concerning their measure.”

James said, “Rabbi, behold then, I have received their number. There are seventy-two measures!” The Lord said, “These are the seventy-two heavens, which are their subordinates. These are the powers of all their might; and they were established by them; and these are they who were distributed everywhere, existing under the [authority] of the twelve archons. The inferior power among them [brought forth] for itself angels [and] unnumbered hosts. Him-who-is, however, has been given [...] on account of [...] Him-who-is [...] they are unnumbered. If you want to give them a number now, you [will] not be able to (do so) until you cast away from yourself blind thought, this bond of flesh which encircles you. And then you will reach Him-who-is. And you will no longer be James; rather you are the One-who-is. And all those who are unnumbered will all have been named.”

(James said, “Then,) Rabbi, in what way shall I reach Him-who-is, since all these powers and these hosts are armed against me?” He said to me, “These powers are not armed against you specifically, but are armed against another. It is against me that they are armed. And they are armed with other [powers]. But they are armed against me [in] judgment. They did not give [...] to me in it [...] through them [...]. In this place [...] suffering, I shall [...]. He will [...] and I shall not rebuke

them. But there shall be within me a silence and a hidden mystery. But I am fainthearted before their anger.”

James said, “Rabbi, if they arm themselves against you, then is there no blame?

You have come with knowledge,
that you might rebuke their forgetfulness.
You have come with recollection,
that you might rebuke their ignorance.

But I was concerned because of you.
For you descended into a great ignorance,
but you have not been defiled by anything in it.
For you descended into a great mindlessness,
and your recollection remained.

You walked in mud,
and your garments were not soiled,
and you have not been buried in their filth,
and you have not been caught.

And I was not like them, but I clothed myself with everything of theirs.
There is in me forgetfulness, yet I remember things that are not theirs.
There is in me [...], and I am in their [...].
[. . .] knowledge [...] not in their sufferings [...]. But I have become afraid [before them], since they rule. For what will they do? What will I be able to say? Or what word will I be able to say that I may escape them?”

The Lord said, “James, I praise your understanding and your fear. If you continue to be distressed, do not be concerned for anything else except your redemption. For behold, I shall complete this destiny upon this earth as I have said from the heavens. And I shall reveal to you your redemption.”

James said, “Rabbi, how, after these things, will you appear to us again? After they seize you, and you complete this destiny, you will go up to Him-who-is.” The Lord said, “James, after these things I shall reveal to you everything, not for your sake alone but for the sake of [the] unbelief of men, so that [faith] may exist in them. For [a] multitude will [attain] to faith [and] they will increase [in . . .]. And after this I shall appear for a reproof to the archons. And I shall reveal to them that he cannot be seized. If they seize him, then he will overpower each of them. But now I shall go. Remember the things I have spoken and let them go up before you.”

James said, “Lord, I shall hasten as you have said.” The Lord said farewell to him and fulfilled what was fitting.

When James heard of his sufferings and was much distressed, they awaited the sign of his coming. And he came after several days. And James was walking upon the mountain, which is called “Gaugelan,” with his disciples, who listened to him [because they had been distressed], and he was [...] a comforter, [saying], “This is [. . .] the (or: a) second [. . . .]” Then the] crowd dispersed, but James remained [...] prayer [...], as was his custom.

And the Lord appeared to him. Then he stopped (his) prayer and embraced him. He kissed him, saying, “Rabbi, I have found you! I have heard of your sufferings, which you endured. And I have been much distressed. My compassion you know. Therefore, on reflection, I was wishing that I would not see this people. They must be judged for these things that they have done. For these things that they have done are contrary to what is fitting.”

The Lord said, “James, do not be concerned for me or for this people. I am he who was within me. Never have I suffered in any way, nor have I been distressed. And this people has done me no harm. But this (people) existed [as] a type of the archons, and it deserved to be [destroyed] through them. But [...] the archons, [...] who (or: which) has [...] but since it (fem.) [...] angry with [. . . The] just [. . .] is his servant. Therefore your name is ‘James the Just.’ You see how you will become sober when you see me. And you stopped this prayer. Now since you are a just man of God, you have embraced me and kissed me. Truly I say to you that you have stirred up great anger and wrath against yourself. But (this has happened) so that these others might come to be.”

But James was timid (and) wept. And he was very distressed. And they both sat down upon a rock. The Lord said to him, “James, thus you will undergo these sufferings. But do not be sad. For the flesh is weak. It will receive what has been ordained for it. But as for you, do not be [timid] or afraid.” The Lord [ceased].

[Now] when James heard these things, he wiped away [the] tears in [his eyes] and very bitter (?) [. . .] which is [...]. The Lord [said] to [him, “James], behold, I shall reveal to you your redemption. When [you] are seized, and you undergo these sufferings, a multitude will arm themselves against you that may seize you. And in particular three of them will seize you—they who sit (there) as toll collectors. Not only do they demand toll, but they also take away souls by theft. When you come into their power, one of them who is their guard will say to you, ‘Who are you or where are you from?’ You are to say to him, ‘I am a son, and I am from the Father.’ He will say to you, ‘What sort of son are you, and to what father do you belong?’ You are to say to him, ‘I am from the Pre-existent Father, and a son in the Pre-existent One.’ [When he says] to you, [...], you are to [say to him, ...] in the [...] that I might [...].

“[...] of] alien things?” You are to say to him, ‘They are not entirely alien, but they are from Achamoth, who is the female. And these she produced as she brought down the race from the Pre-existent One. So then they are not alien, but they are ours. They are indeed ours because she who is mistress of them is from the Pre-existent One. At the same time they are alien because the Pre-existent One did not have intercourse with her, when she produced them.’ When he also says to you, ‘Where will you go?’, you are to say to him, ‘To the place from which I have come, there shall I return.’ And if you say these things, you will escape their attacks.

“But when you come to [these] three detainers [who] take away souls by theft in that place [...] these. You [...] a vessel [...] much more than [...] of the one (fem.) whom you [...] for [...] her root. You too will be sober [...]. But I shall call [upon] the imperishable knowledge, which is Sophia who is in the Father (and) who is the mother of Achamoth. Achamoth had no father nor male consort, but she is female from a female. She produced you (pl.) without a male, since she was alone (and) in ignorance as to what [lives through] her mother because she thought that she alone existed. But [I] shall cry out to her mother. And then they will fall into confusion (and) will

blame their root and the race [of] their mother. [But] you will go up to [what is] yours [...] you will [...] the [Pre-existent One].

“[They are a] type [of the] twelve disciples and [the] twelve pairs, [...] Achamoth, which is translated ‘Sophia.’ And who I myself am, and (who) the imperishable Sophia (is) through whom you will be redeemed, and (who are) all the sons of Him-who-is—these things they have known and have hidden within them. You are to hide within you, and you are to keep silence. But you are to reveal them to Addai. When you [depart], immediately war will be [made] with this land. [Weep], then, for him who dwells in Jerusalem. But let Addai take these things to heart. In the tenth year let Addai sit and write them down. And when he writes them down [...] and they are to give them [...] he has the [...] he is [called] Levi. Then he is to bring [...] word [...] from [what I] said earlier [...] a woman [...] Jerusalem in her [...] and] he begets [two] sons through her. [They are to] inherit these things [and] the understanding of him who [...] exalts. And they are to receive [...] through him from his intellect. Now, the younger of them is greater. And may these things remain hidden in him until [he] comes to the age of seventeen years [...] beginning [...] through [them]. They will pursue him exceedingly, since [they are] from his [...] companions. He will be proclaimed [through] them, and [they will] proclaim this word. [Then he will become] a seed of [...].”

James said, “[I am] satisfied [...] and they are [...] my soul. Yet [another thing] I ask of you: who are the [seven] women who have [been] your disciples? And behold, all women bless you. I also am amazed how [powerless] vessels have become strong by a perception which is in them.” [The] Lord [said], “You [...] well [...] a spirit [of ...], a [spirit] of thought, [a spirit] of counsel of [a ...], a spirit [...], a spirit of knowledge [...] of their fear. [...] when we had passed through [the breath] of [this] archon who is [named] Adonaios [...] him and [...] he was ignorant [...] when I came forth from him, [he] remembered that I am [a] son of his. He was gracious [to me] at that time as his son. And then, before *appeared here, cast them among [this] people. And from the [place] of heaven the prophets [...].*”

James [said], “Rabbi, [...] I [...] all together [...] in them especially [...].” The Lord said, “[James], praise [you ...] walk upon the earth [...] the words while he [. . .]’ on the [...]. For cast away from [you the] cup, which is bitterness. For some from [...] set themselves against you. For [you have begun] to understand [their roots] from beginning to end. Cast away from yourself all lawlessness. And beware lest they envy you. When you speak these words of this [perception], encourage these [four]: Salome and Mariam [and Martha and Arsinoe ...] since he takes some [...] to me he is [...] burnt offerings and [...]. But I [...] not in this way; but [...] first-fruits of the [...] upward [...] so that the power [of God might] appear. The perishable has [gone up] to the imperishable and the female element has attained to this male element.”

James said, “Rabbi, into these three (things), then, has their [...] been cast. For they have been reviled, [and they have been] persecuted [. . .]. Behold ’[. . .] everything ’[. . .] from anyone [...]. For you have received [...] of knowledge. [And ...] that what is the [...] go [...] you will [find ...]. But I shall go [forth] and shall reveal that they believed in you [that they may] be content with their [blessing] and salvation, and this revelation may come to pass.” And he went at that time [immediately] and rebuked the twelve, and cast [out] of them contentment [concerning the] way of knowledge [...].

[...]. And the majority of [them ...] when they [saw, the] messenger took in [...]. The others [...] said, “[...] him from this earth. For [he is] not [worthy] of life.” These, then, [were] afraid.

*They arose, saying, “We have no part in this blood, for a just man will perish through injustice.”
James departed so that [...] look '[. . .] for we (?) [...] him.*